

Wanting Echo Zhao

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Summary

Deaf data science student and interdisciplinary researcher-in-training with experience spanning research, strategy, accessibility, design, and business operations. Experienced in synthesizing complex information into actionable insights through qualitative research, data analysis, and narrative communication. Motivated by lived experience with disability and a strong interest in accessibility, online communities, information sharing, and human-centred technology. Currently pursuing a Master's degree in Data Science at Monash University Malaysia.

Work Experience

Woman Alliance Group — Research & Strategy Intern

Jan 2026 – Apr 2026

- Co-authored and supported editorial development of *Symbiotic Workplace: 2026 China Inclusive Workplace Exemplary Case White Paper*, covering 20 companies across six domains: inclusive culture, gender equality, intergenerational integration, disability inclusion, employee well-being, and CSR.
- Designed and structured a new product framework, including a Figma-based promotion handbook, improving clarity and usability of internal knowledge assets.
- Conducted research on ESG and ERG topics, synthesizing findings into structured outputs including reports, presentation decks, and web content.

Clearwater — Research & Strategy Intern

Jul 2025

- Led research on DEI visibility, gender equity practices, and employer branding strategies across 18 global competitors (Big Four, mid-tier, boutique).
- Evaluated certification pathways (IIP, Good Work Standard, Best Companies) and produced actionable recommendations for improving external DEI storytelling.
- Authored a 30-page research handbook and delivered a 30-minute executive presentation outlining strategic pathways for inclusive employer branding.
- Synthesized qualitative and quantitative insights into a structured framework usable by HR, People & Culture, and leadership teams.

China Education Symposium at Harvard University — Design Director

Nov 2024 – Nov 2025

- Directed design strategy for a global education symposium, creating inclusive visual content and communication materials for diverse audiences.
- Directed cross-cultural design teams to produce inclusive, accessible digital and print materials.
- Developed storytelling-based presentations and handbooks, integrating user-centered design principles to enhance audience engagement.
- Collaborated with speakers, researchers, and organizers to ensure clarity, accessibility, and consistency across all outputs.

Apple Inc. — Operations Specialist | Business Expert | Specialist

Shenzhen, China • Oct 2021 – Apr 2024

Operations Specialist - Led cross-functional operations projects improving efficiency and business process integration across retail and back-office teams. - Supported data-driven decision-making by collecting, analyzing, and reporting operational metrics to drive actionable insights. - Coordinated high-stakes business deliveries, including a 22-device launch-day fulfillment praised for accuracy and speed.

Business Expert - Drove ¥420,653 in revenue through strategic customer engagement and data-driven communication. - Conducted a rapid audit of 428 retail businesses, identifying new sales opportunities and supporting market expansion. - Organized a month-long business development initiative for 150 staff, increasing qualified leads by 30%.

Specialist - Delivered patient, accessible product guidance for diverse customers, contributing to high CSAT scores. - Supported newcomer onboarding and modeled customer-centric communication.

Diversity & Accessibility (DNA) Ambassador — Volunteer - Co-led Diversity & Accessibility sessions for regional teams, promoting inclusive customer experiences. - Educated staff on communication strategies for Deaf and diverse customers, strengthening service confidence. - Contributed to internal initiatives fostering belonging, empathy, and accessibility awareness.

Education

Master of Data Science — Monash University Malaysia

Expected Graduation: October 2027

Bachelor in Statistics — Huaqiao University, China

Sep 2016 – Jul 2021

Research Interests

- Accessibility, disability, and Deaf communities
- Online communities and community knowledge sharing
- Human-computer interaction (HCI) and participatory design
- Social media, information access, and digital inclusion
- AI-assisted knowledge organization and accessibility tools

Projects

NF2 Accessibility & UX Case Study — Independent Research Project - Conducted a UX-focused case study exploring information-access and support needs among people affected by Neurofibromatosis Type 2 (NF2), combining literature review, quantitative research, qualitative interviews, and user-centred design methods. - Applied empathy maps, user stories, personas, user journey mapping, problem definition, value proposition exploration, and ideation to translate research findings into accessibility-focused design opportunities. - Developed the project from a Google UX Design Certificate case study into a potential Master's research direction, demonstrating the ability to connect structured UX practice with independent academic inquiry.

Personal Website & Accessibility-Focused Digital Tools - Designed and developed a personal website showcasing research interests, analytical writing, accessibility projects, and professional work. - Independently designed and built web-based tools, including a fingerspelling dictionary prototype created to address vocabulary lookup challenges encountered during independent sign-language learning. - Applied self-taught web development, design, and usability principles to transform personal learning barriers into functional prototypes.

Independent Research & Writing - Published essays and long-form analyses covering accessibility, technology, organizations, education, and personal experience. - Conducted independent investigation into Deaf communities, sign-language learning, accessibility barriers, and community knowledge-sharing practices. - Demonstrated ability to synthesize information from diverse sources into structured insights and research-inspired project concepts.

Accessibility & Community Engagement

Deaf Accessibility Advocacy & Community Projects - Leveraged lived experience as a Deaf individual to explore accessibility, communication barriers, and inclusive technology through independent projects and research. - Developed accessibility-focused digital prototypes, including a fingerspelling dictionary tool, to address challenges encountered during sign-language learning and information access. - Promoted accessibility awareness through writing, public communication, and community-oriented digital initiatives. - Investigated knowledge-sharing practices within Deaf and disability communities, with a growing interest in how online communities organize, preserve, and surface lived experience.

Skills

- Data Analysis and Visualization (R, SQL, Tableau, R Shiny, Python)
- AI-Assisted Research & Productivity (AI tools for research synthesis, ideation, writing support, analysis, and workflow acceleration)
- Information Synthesis & Knowledge Organization
- UX Research & Human-Centred Design (qualitative research, user journeys, personas, ideation, prototyping)
- Accessibility & Inclusive Design
- Web Design & Front-End Development (Self-Taught)
- Project & Stakeholder Coordination; Cross-Cultural Communication

Languages

- Chinese (Native)
- English (Professional Working Proficiency)
- ASL/CSL/BIM (Basic communication)